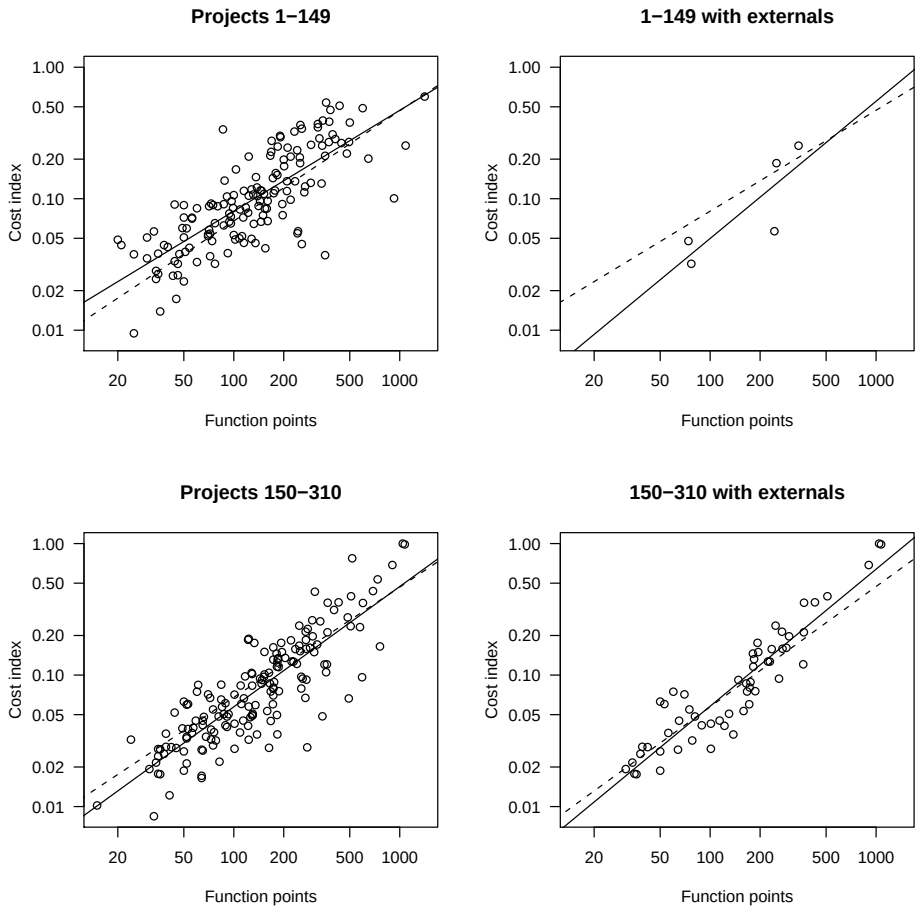

Figure 6: Visualization of the linear model for different groups. The dotted line shows the fitted line without the split taking place. For the plots on the left it is for the model without groups; for the plots on the right, it is the same as the solid line on the left of the plot.

and external counters, but now for early and late projects. In Table 7, these are shown as models 5 to 7. Now it appears that in terms of BIC, model 5 is the best model. This model has different values for the β model parameter for early and late projects. Model 7 is better in terms of AIC, and would be also a good choice, but as we are seeking a true model, we prefer model 5 for now.

After we have added the difference between early and late projects to our model, giving model number 5, we investigated the possibility of an even better model by taking potential differences between external and internal counters into account. For the models shown in Table 8 variables α_e and β_e are either zero or have a value, depending on whether the project is externally counted. Variables α_{ae} and β_{ae} denote four different parameters for the four situations (project among first 149 true/false and project counted by externals true/false). None of the models shown in Table 8 scores better on